

Opella Healthcare Italy

PACKAGING TEAM

Code:

941577

Update:

V01 - 09-07-2025

GMID code:

513001

Current item code:

845846

Product/Item type:

Istruzione

Maalox

Stickpack

Country:

Malaysia

Artwork by:

Origgio

Plant:

Origgio

Technical Data

Format:

Stesa 157 x 315 mm

Plant barcode:

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Number of Colours:

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GDO - Graphic Department Origgio

Opella Healthcare Italy S.r.l. - Viale Europa, 11

21040 Origgio (VA) - Italy - Tel. +39 - 02 96 10 559

Impianti di proprietà Opella Healthcare Italy S.r.l.

Vietata la manomissione - Rendere dopo la stampa

MAALOX® oral suspension in sachets



15 mm

QUALITATIVE AND QUANTITATIVE COMPOSITION
Aluminium oxide 230.00 mg
As hydrated Aluminium oxide 460.00 mg
Magnesium hydroxide 400.00 mg
for one sachet

PRODUCT DESCRIPTION
MAALOX® oral suspension is a white to faintly yellow, homogeneous suspension. It is packed into sachets of 4.3 ml equivalent to 6 g of suspension.

PHARMACEUTICAL FORM
Oral suspension in sachets.

CLINICAL PARTICULARS
Therapeutic indications
As an antacid for symptomatic relief of hyperacidity associated with the diagnosis of peptic ulcer, gastritis, peptic esophagitis, gastric hyperacidity, heartburn, or hiatal hernia.

Posology and method of administration
FOR USE IN ADULTS ONLY (aged 15 years and over)

- 1 to 2 sachets per intake when heartburn or acid regurgitation occurs.
- MAALOX® oral suspension may be taken 20 minutes to one hour after meals and at bedtime or as required.
- Maximum number of doses per day: 6.
- No more than 12 sachets should be taken per day.
- Knead the sachet carefully before opening.

Drink the suspension as is; do not dilute.

Contraindications

- Hypersensitivity to any of the ingredients of the product,
- Severe renal insufficiency, as the medicinal product contains magnesium.
- Patients with porphyria.
- Generally contraindicated in children.
- Cachexia

Special warnings and precautions for use
Aluminium hydroxide may cause constipation and magnesium salts overdose may cause hypomotility of the intestine; large doses of this medicinal product may trigger or aggravate intestinal obstruction and ileus in patients with higher risk, such as those with renal impairment, primary constipation, impaired intestinal motility, infants (0 to 24 months) and the elderly.
Aluminium hydroxide is not well absorbed from the gastrointestinal tract, and systemic effects are therefore rare in patients with normal renal function. However, excessive doses or long-term use, or even normal doses in patients with low-phosphorus diets or in infants (0 to 24 months), may lead to phosphate depletion (due to aluminium-phosphate binding) accompanied by increased bone resorption and hypercalciuria with the risk of osteomalacia. Medical advice is recommended in case of long-term use or in patients at risk of hypophosphatemia.
In patients with renal impairment, plasma levels of aluminium and magnesium tend to increase, which causes hyperalumaemia and hypermagnesemia respectively. In these patients, long-term exposure to high doses of aluminium and magnesium salts may lead to encephalopathy, dementia, microcytic anaemia or it may worsen dialysis-induced osteomalacia.
Medical monitoring is required in patients with mild to moderate renal impairment, and long-term use of the medicinal product should be avoided.
Aluminium hydroxide may not be safe for use in porphyria patients undergoing haemodialysis (see section Contraindications).
Long-term use of the medicinal product should be avoided in these patients.
MAALOX® oral suspension, due to its composition, does not tend to affect the behaviour of the intestine. However, in some particularly sensitive subjects and at high doses, an acceleration of intestinal transit is possible.

MAALOX® contains:

- approximately 3 g of sucrose per sachet. This should be taken into account in patients with diabetes mellitus (if more than one sachet is taken per day). Patients with rare hereditary problems of fructose intolerance, glucose-galactose malabsorption or sucrase-isomaltase insufficiency should not take this medicine.
- 140 mg sorbitol per sachet. Patients with hereditary fructose intolerance (HFI) should not take/be given this medicinal product.
- less than 1 mmol sodium (23 mg) per dose, that is to say essentially ‘sodium-free’.

Paediatric population
Use of magnesium hydroxide in small children, particularly those with kidney impairment or dehydration, may result in hypermagnesemia.

Interaction with other medicinal products and other forms of interaction
Antacids interact with certain other medicinal products taken orally.

Combinations requiring precautions for use:
A reduction in the gastrointestinal absorption of concomitantly administered medicinal products is observed.
As a precautionary measure, an interval should be allowed between taking antacids and other medications.
If possible, allow an interval of more than 2 hours (4 hours for fluoroquinolones) between taking this medicinal product and:
+ H2 antihistamines
+ Antituberculosis agents: ethambutol, isoniazid (oral use)
+ Antiviral treatments in combination with tenofovir alafenamide fumarate/ emtricitabide/ sodium bictegravir
+ Atenolol, metoprolol, propranolol
+ Bisphosphanates
+ Cefdinir
+ Cefpodoxime
+ Chloroquine
+ Dasatinib
+ Diffunisal
+ Digoxin
+ Eltrombopag olamine
+ Elvitegravir
+ Fexofenadine
+ Fluoroquinolones
+ Indomethacin
+ Iron (salts)
+ Fluoroquinolones
+ Sodium fluoride



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+ Glucocorticoids (described for prednisolone and dexamethasone)

+ Indomethacin

+ Kayexalate

+ Ketoconazole

+ Lansoprazole

+ Levothyroxine

+ Lincosamides

+ Nilotinib

+ Phenothiazine neuroleptics

+ Penicillamine

+ Raltegravir

+ Rilpivirine

+ Riociguat

+ Rosuvastatin

+ Tetracyclines

Combination with integrase inhibitors (dolutegravir, raltegravir, bictegravir) and MAALOX® oral suspension should be avoided.

Concomitant use with quinidine may increase the serum levels of quinidine and lead to quinidine overdosage.

Concomitant use of aluminium hydroxide and citrates may result in increased aluminium levels, especially in patients with renal impairment.

Urine alkalinisation following magnesium hydroxide administration may affect the excretion of some drugs; increased excretion of salicylates has been observed.

Pregnancy and lactation

Pregnancy

The medicinal product should only be used if absolutely necessary, under direct medical supervision, after having evaluated the expected benefits for the mother compared with the possible risk to the foetus or infant.

Lactation

Because of the limited maternal absorption when taken in accordance with the indicated dosage regimen (see section Posology and method of administration), aluminium hydroxide and its magnesium salt combinations are considered compatible with breastfeeding.

Effects on ability to drive and use machines

This product has no or negligible influence on the ability to drive and use machines.

Undesirable effects

The frequency of the undesirable effects listed below is defined using the following conventions: common (≥1/100 to <1/10); uncommon (≥1/1 000 to <1/100); rare (≥1/10 000 to <1/1 000); very rare (<1/10 000); not known (cannot be estimated from the available data).

Immune system disorders:

Not known: angioedema, anaphylactic reactions, hypersensitivity reactions, urticaria, pruritus.

Gastrointestinal disorders:

Uncommon: diarrhoea or constipation (see section Special warnings and precautions for use). Not known: abdominal pain.

Metabolism and nutrition disorders:

Very rare: hypermagnesemia, which has been observed with prolonged use in patients with kidney impairment.

Not known: (cannot be estimated from the available data): hyperalbuminaemia, hypophosphatemia, in prolonged use or at high doses, or even normal doses of the medicinal product in patients on low- phosphorus diets, or in infants (0 to 24 months), which may result in increased bone resorption, hypercalciuria or osteomalacia (see section Special warnings and precautions for use).

Overdose

There is very limited experience with deliberate overdose. Cases of overdose with aluminium salts are more likely to occur in patients with severe chronic renal impairment, with the following symptoms: encephalopathy, seizures and dementia, hypermagnesemia.

The most frequently reported symptoms of acute overdose with aluminium hydroxide, and in combination with magnesium salts, include diarrhoea, abdominal pain and vomiting.

High doses of this medicinal product may cause or aggravate intestinal obstruction and ileus in patients at risk (see section Special warnings and precautions for use).

Treatment should be symptomatic and include general supportive measures.

Aluminium and magnesium are eliminated through the urinary route; treatment of magnesium overdose consists of rehydration and forced diuresis. In case of renal impairment, haemodialysis or peritoneal dialysis is necessary.

PHARMACOLOGICAL PROPERTIES

Pharmacodynamic properties

Pharmacotherapeutic group: Antacids; ATC code: A02AD01.

Mechanism of action

The antacid activity is carried out in the stomach where, at suitable doses, the magnesium hydroxide and aluminium hydroxide neutralize the production of gastric acid. The constipating effect of aluminium hydroxide is counteracted by the laxative effect of the magnesium hydroxide.

Pharmacokinetic properties

Absorption

When administered orally, aluminium hydroxide and magnesium hydroxide react with the hydrochloric acid produced in the stomach to form salts, which are only partly absorbed.

Excretion

Absorbed salts are excreted mainly in the urine.

Storage condition

Do not store above 30°C

PRESENTATION

Box of 6 sachets, box of 20 sachets.

MANUFACTURER:

Opella Healthcare Italy S.r.l.

Viale Europa, 11 - 21040 Origgio (VA)

Italy

MARKETING AUTHORIZATION HOLDER:

DKSH Malaysia Sdn Bhd

B-11-01, The Ascent, Paradigm

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47301, Petaling Jaya,

Selangor Darul Ehsan, Malaysia

DATE OF REVISION OF THE TEXT

May 2025 (based on IT SmPC June 2022)



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